

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET C — NCERT EXEMPLAR, IN-TEXT SOURCES & TRICKY QUESTIONS****CHAPTER 04: EARLY HUMANS AND BEGINNING OF CIVILISATION**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-C-04

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET C - NCERT Exemplar & Tricky Questions):

1. The question paper comprises **25 NCERT Exemplar & Critical Application Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Tests **in-text source boxes, fine glossary definitions, historical source extracts, and tricky boundary cases**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking for incorrect answers.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

 **NCERT IN-TEXT & EXEMPLAR TIER:** Questions in this set explore subtle details, specialized definitions, and non-intuitive concepts drawn directly from official NCERT text margins, source boxes, and glossary entries.

Q.1 What is the primary archaeological significance of the discovery of 'steatite micro-beads' (some less than 1 mm in diameter) at Harappa and Chanhudaro?

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|---|--|
| (A) They demonstrate unprecedented microscopic pyrotechnology, precision drilling, and chemical glazing capabilities among Harappan craft specialists | (B) They prove that Harappans possessed modern electronic lasers |
| (C) They were used exclusively as edible food grains during famines | (D) They were manufactured by dropping hot sand into ocean waves |

Q.2 In Harappan town planning, why did the residential houses in the Lower Town have their entrance doors opening into narrow side lanes rather than the main streets?

- | | |
|---|---|
| (A) To maintain household acoustic and visual privacy, and protect family living quarters from street dust, noise, and vehicular cart traffic | (B) Because ancient religious laws prohibited looking at main roads |
| (C) Because Harappan citizens had no eyes to see main streets | (D) Because main streets were flooded with boiling water continuously |

Q.3 What unique architectural feature was discovered at Kalibangan and Banawali that was notably ABSENT in the coastal site of Lothal?

- | | |
|---|---|
| (A) Mud-brick fortification platforms with series of clay-lined sacrificial 'Fire Altars' (*Havan Kundas*) containing ash, charcoal, and animal bones | (B) A brick tidal dockyard with sluice gates |
| (C) A monumental stone rainwater harvesting reservoir | (D) A wooden sign-board with ten pictographic Indus signs |

Q.4 The Harappan civilization utilized an elaborate system of standardized weights. What was the exact ratio sequence of the smaller binary denominations before switching to decimal multiples?

- | | |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| (A) 1 : 2 : 4 : 8 : 16 : 32 : 64 | (B) 1 : 3 : 9 : 27 : 81 : 243 |
| (C) 1 : 5 : 25 : 125 : 625 | (D) 1 : 10 : 100 : 1000 : 10000 |

Q.5 What is the 'lost-wax' (cire perdue) process used by Harappan artisans to cast the famous bronze 'Dancing Girl'?

- (A) A model was sculpted in beeswax, coated with clay, heated to melt and drain the wax out, and molten bronze was poured into the hollow clay mold
- (B) Bronze metal was hammered into shape with cold stone axes
- (C) Wax was mixed with water and left to dry in the sun
- (D) Artisans carved the statue out of a single piece of cold iron

Q.6 Which distinctive pigment was predominantly used by Mesolithic hunters to paint the rock shelters of Bhimbetka, and where did they obtain it?

- (A) Red ochre (hematite / geru) obtained by grinding iron-oxide mineral nodules with animal fat and water
- (B) Synthetic chemical acrylic paint imported from Mesopotamia
- (C) Crushed blue plastic beads found in caves
- (D) Pure liquid petroleum oil from deep wells

Q.7 Why do archaeologists consider the mature Harappan site of Shortughai in Badakhshan (northern Afghanistan) an extraordinary anomaly in Indus settlement geography?

- (A) It was an isolated trading colony established over 1,000 km north of the Indus plain specifically to monopolize access to rare Lapis Lazuli and Central Asian tin mines
- (B) It was built entirely underwater in a mountain lake
- (C) The inhabitants were Roman soldiers who traveled through time
- (D) It had no buildings and was solely an agricultural potato farm

Q.8 In the Indus Valley Civilisation, what was the primary purpose of the 'Citadel' (Upper Town) located on an elevated artificial mud-brick platform in the western part of cities?

- (A) It housed monumental public administrative, civic, and ritual structures (Great Bath, Granary, Assembly Halls) and protected ruling elites from flood inundation
- (B) It was a playground reserved exclusively for children's games
- (C) It was a stable where thousands of cavalry horses were kept
- (D) It was an open-air market where foreign merchants sold plastic toys

Q.9 What does the discovery of etched carnelian beads in both Harappa and the Royal Cemetery of Ur in Mesopotamia reveal about ancient trade technology?

- (A) Harappans perfected a sophisticated chemical etching technique using alkali (soda) to etch permanent white geometric patterns onto red carnelian gemstones for luxury export
- (B) Mesopotamians invaded India and forced Harappans to buy their beads
- (C) Beads were used as explosive cannonballs in ancient wars
- (D) The beads were painted with modern watercolor paints that washed off in water

Q.10 Which Harappan city is uniquely characterized by the COMPLETE ABSENCE of a fortified Citadel, consisting exclusively of an open Lower Town?

- (A) Chanhudaro
- (B) Mohenjo-daro
- (C) Harappa
- (D) Dholavira

Q.11 What material was used by Harappans to manufacture 'faience' bangles and cosmetic vessels, and why was it considered a luxury material?

- (A) Finely ground silica sand quartz mixed with gum and glaze, then fired in kilns to produce a shiny, glassy turquoise-blue surface; it was difficult and expensive to make
- (B) It was carved out of solid natural blocks of pure ice
- (C) It was made from cow dung dried in the sun
- (D) It was manufactured from recycled plastic bottles

Q.12 What was the function of the massive stone structures termed 'reservoirs' in Dholavira, which covered approximately 10% of the entire fortified city area?

- (A) Harvesting and storing over 250,000 cubic meters of surface monsoon runoff channeled from seasonal rivulets (Mansar and Manhar) through check-dams and rock-cut cisterns
- (B) Breeding grounds for dangerous deep-sea sharks
- (C) Massive chemical acid tanks used to dissolve garbage
- (D) Public amphitheaters where musical concerts were performed

Q.13 At the coastal site of Lothal, what evidence confirms that the large brick basin was an engineered tidal dockyard rather than a domestic water irrigation tank?

- (A) A masonry sluice gate, an inlet channel linked to the river Bhogavo, an overflow spillway, heavy stone anchor stones, and marine micro-fossils (foraminifera) in silt layers
- (B) The presence of modern diesel fuel pumps along the basin walls
- (C) A sign written in modern English saying 'Harappan Royal Dockyard'
- (D) The basin was located at the top of a 5,000-meter snow mountain

Q.14 What linguistic and contextual clue connects the Mesopotamian cuneiform name 'Meluhha' with the Harappan Civilisation?

- (A) Mesopotamian tablets describe Meluhha as a distant land of seafarers exporting carnelian, lapis lazuli, copper, ivory, and exotic birds ('haja-bird', identified as the peacock)
- (B) Meluhha was recorded as being located on the moon
- (C) Meluhha was an ancient Greek city located in Europe
- (D) Meluhha exported only modern industrial television sets

Q.15 Why were the burials excavated in the Cemetery R-37 at Harappa characterized by simple wooden coffins and pottery vessels rather than massive gold hoards?

- (A) Harappan mortuary ideology did not emphasize conspicuous burial wealth, reflecting cultural values where precious metals remained in circulation rather than interred permanently
- (B) Harappans had zero metal of any kind in their civilization
- (C) Ancient laws required all dead citizens to be thrown into the sea
- (D) Harappan graves were excavated by wild animals that ate all the gold

Q.16 What is the 'Dholavira Signboard' discovered in the western chamber of the northern gate of the Citadel?

- (A) A wooden board inlaid with ten large Indus script signs made of white crystalline gypsum, each approximately 37 cm high and 27 cm wide
- (B) A bronze plate inscribed with the modern Indian national anthem
- (C) A roadmap showing the directions to modern Delhi and Mumbai
- (D) A stone sculpture depicting an ancient cricket match

Q.17 Which precious green gemstone was imported by the Harappans from the Pamir Mountains and Central Asia for carving ornamental beads?

- (A) Jadeite (Jade)
- (B) Lapis Lazuli
- (C) Carnelian
- (D) Amethyst

Q.18 What is the primary technological evidence that the Harappans did NOT possess the horse (*Equus caballus*) as a dominant domestic animal during the mature urban phase?

- (A) Horses are completely absent on thousands of carved steatite seals, sealings, terracotta toys, and osteological animal bone assemblages across mature sites
- (B) Ancient texts state that all horses were banned by imperial decree
- (C) Harappans were terrified of four-legged animals
- (D) Horses were invented only in the 19th century in America

Q.19 How did Harappan city engineers ensure that wastewater from domestic second-story bathrooms was transported safely to the street drains without splashing?

- (A) Vertical terracotta pipes (drainage conduits) were embedded directly inside the thickness of the house's exterior brick walls, discharging into street cesspits
- (B) Residents threw wastewater directly out of upper-floor windows
- (C) Houses had no second floors anywhere in the civilization
- (D) Wastewater was collected by carrier pigeons

Q.20 What agricultural feature was discovered at the Harappan site of Shortughai in Afghanistan that demonstrates adaptation to arid Central Asian geography?

- (A) An engineered network of irrigation canals excavated in the soil to divert river water to dry wheat and barley fields
- (B) Giant electric water sprinklers powered by steam
- (C) Underground tunnels filled with imported seawater
- (D) Floating hydroponic gardens built on rafts

Q.21 What soft mineral paste was applied to the surface of steatite seals before heating them in specialized kilns to produce a durable white finish?

- (A) A silica-rich talc-magnesium slurry glaze
- (B) Pure liquid gold paint
- (C) Crushed red brick dust mixed with oil
- (D) Animal blood mixed with ash

Q.22 What does the discovery of copper axes and chisels in mature Harappan sites containing trace percentages of arsenic indicate about ancient metallurgy?

- (A) Harappans deliberately produced arsenical bronze alloys to harden copper and improve casting fluidity before tin became widely available
- (B) Arsenic was used by enemies to poison the metal tools
- (C) The tools were manufactured accidentally without human knowledge
- (D) Copper tools were too soft to cut wood and were used as mirrors

Q.23 Why is the Mesolithic rock art site of Bhimbetka considered an invaluable record of prehistoric human-animal relationships?

- (A) It depicts over 29 species of wild animals (bison, tigers, rhinoceros, boars, deer) portrayed with dynamic anatomical realism alongside collective hunting scenes and ritual dances
- (B) It depicts humans flying on mechanical airplanes
- (C) It depicts only domesticated farm sheep eating grass in wooden barns
- (D) It contains portraits of modern political leaders

Q.24 What does the term 'Palaeolithic' literally mean from its Greek linguistic roots?

- (A) 'Palaeos' (Old) and 'Lithos' (Stone) = Old Stone Age
- (B) 'Polished' and 'Iron' = Polished Iron Age
- (C) 'Plant' and 'Leaf' = Ancient Leaf Age
- (D) 'Planet' and 'Light' = Planet Light Age

Q.25 In summary, why did the urban civilization of the Indus Valley stand out as uniquely advanced among all contemporary Bronze Age civilizations of Egypt and Mesopotamia?

- (A) Its universal town planning, standardized metrology, subterranean public sanitation, and egalitarian civic infrastructure were unmatched in antiquity
- (B) It possessed motorized tanks and jet aircraft
- (C) It conquered and ruled the entire continent of Africa
- (D) It had zero agriculture and imported 100% of its food from outer space

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET C)

01	(A) (B) (C) (D)	02	(A) (B) (C) (D)	03	(A) (B) (C) (D)	04	(A) (B) (C) (D)	05	(A) (B) (C) (D)
06	(A) (B) (C) (D)	07	(A) (B) (C) (D)	08	(A) (B) (C) (D)	09	(A) (B) (C) (D)	10	(A) (B) (C) (D)
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16	(A) (B) (C) (D)	17	(A) (B) (C) (D)	18	(A) (B) (C) (D)	19	(A) (B) (C) (D)	20	(A) (B) (C) (D)
21	(A) (B) (C) (D)	22	(A) (B) (C) (D)	23	(A) (B) (C) (D)	24	(A) (B) (C) (D)	25	(A) (B) (C) (D)

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS (SET C)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & In-Depth Conceptual Solution
Q.1	(A)	Manufacturing 1-mm micro-beads of talc/steatite required grinding paste, extruding tiny cylinders, microscopic drilling, and heating to $>1000^{\circ}\text{C}$ to induce enstatite hardening.
Q.2	(A)	Courtyard-centered architecture prioritized privacy: blank outer walls, offset entryways from narrow side alleys, and ground-floor rooms without street-facing windows kept interiors quiet.
Q.3	(A)	Kalibangan and Banawali feature series of ritual fire altars with terracotta cakes and charcoal, whereas Lothal is characterized by its tidal brick dockyard and bead factories.
Q.4	(A)	Harappan metrology: binary denominations (1, 2, 4, 8, 16 up to 64, where unit 16 weighed ~ 13.7 g), followed by decimal multiples (160, 200, 320, 640, 1600, 3200, etc.).
Q.5	(A)	Lost-wax casting: a wax effigy is coated with refractory clay; heating drains the wax; molten bronze ($\text{Cu}+\text{Sn}$) fills the hollow cavity; upon cooling, the clay shell is broken away.
Q.6	(A)	Bhimbetka rock art used natural mineral pigments: red from pulverized hematite/geru (Fe_2O_3), white from limestone/kaolin, and green from copper minerals, bound with water or fat.
Q.7	(A)	Shortughai was an imperial trading enclave along the Oxus River, featuring classic Indus seals, pottery, and weights positioned strategically to control Badakhshan lapis lazuli.
Q.8	(A)	The western Citadel sat on massive mud-brick terraces 7–12 meters high, segregating elite public civic, ritual, and storage facilities from the residential Lower Town.
Q.9	(A)	Alkali-etched carnelian was a signature Indus technological monopoly: painting potash/soda patterns and firing to create indelible white lines on red carnelian (*guglu*).
Q.10	(A)	Chanhudaro (in modern Sindh) is the only excavated major Indus urban center that lacked a fortified Citadel mound, functioning primarily as a craft manufacturing town.
Q.11	(A)	Faience is an artificial glassy composite of crushed quartz sand, mineral colorants, and flux fused at high temperatures ($>950^{\circ}\text{C}$); its rarity made it a high-status prestige good.
Q.12	(A)	Dholavira's 16 colossal rock-cut reservoirs interconnected by drains and sluices stored over 2.5 lakh cubic meters of water, sustaining an island city in the arid Rann of Kutch.
Q.13	(A)	Lothal's basin ($214 \times 36 \text{ m}$) features burnt brick walls, a 7-meter inlet lock-gate, grooved sluice spillways, perforated stone mooring anchors, and marine micro-organisms.
Q.14	(A)	King Sargon of Akkad (c. 2334 BCE) boasted that ships from Meluhha moored at his quays, laden with carnelian, lapis lazuli, ivory, and *haja* (peacock, *mayura*).
Q.15	(A)	Unlike Egyptian Pharaohs whose tombs hoarded national bullion, Harappans interred modest ceramic vessels, shell bangles, and copper mirrors, recycling precious metals in the living economy.
Q.16	(A)	The Dholavira Signboard (c. 2500 BCE) is one of the world's earliest public monumental signboards: 10 large crystalline gypsum glyphs once mounted over a civic gateway.
Q.17	(A)	Jade and jadeite ornamental stones were procured through high-altitude Central Asian exchange networks across the Pamirs.
Q.18	(A)	The zebu bull, unicorn, elephant, tiger, and rhinoceros appear prolifically on seals and terracotta models, while true domesticated horse remains are conspicuously absent in mature strata.
Q.19	(A)	Upper-floor latrines and bathrooms emptied via vertical terracotta interlocking drainpipes concealed inside brick wall cavities, feeding into ground-level covered chutes.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & In-Depth Conceptual Solution
Q.20	(A)	Unlike the seasonal flood-inundation farming of the Indus plain, Shortughai features direct archaeological evidence of stone-and-earth diversion canals for irrigation.
Q.21	(A)	Steatite seals were carved from soft soapstone, coated with a finely ground talc/alkali chemical paste, and kiln-fired to $>900^{\circ}\text{C}$ to form an enstatite glazed white surface.
Q.22	(A)	Arsenical copper alloys (1–4% As) were intentional early Bronze Age metallurgical techniques: arsenic deoxidized molten copper, improved tensile hardness, and reduced casting bubbles.
Q.23	(A)	Bhimbetka's rock paintings span the Upper Palaeolithic through Mesolithic, chronicling animal vitality, communal drive hunts, ritual dances, and animal-mask ceremonies.
Q.24	(A)	Coined by Sir John Lubbock in 1865, 'Palaeolithic' combines Greek <i>*palaios*</i> (ancient/old) and <i>*lithos*</i> (stone), contrasting with 'Neolithic' (new stone).
Q.25	(A)	While Egypt built royal tombs and Mesopotamia built royal ziggurats, Harappans directed civic surplus into public sanitation, standard weights, and equitable urban hygiene.